

HOUSE BILL 2263

By Martin G

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 39,
Chapter 14, Part 2, relative to cruelty to animals.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 39-14-217(b), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(b) Except as provided in subsections (d) and (e), a person commits aggravated cruelty to a livestock animal who, in a depraved and sadistic manner, intentionally:

(1) Starves the livestock animal to death without justifiable or lawful purpose; or

(2) Engages in any of the conduct described in subdivisions (c)(1)-(12), the conduct results in serious bodily injury to the animal or the death of the animal, and is without justifiable or lawful purpose.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.